

LOPTR LAB · GODS OF MAYHEM

Veiled Dominion: Duet

Media kit · Gods of Mayhem rollout, celebrating the creation of Death’s Daughter

“I was born where Death wanted a witness. Every pawn that reaches the far rank becomes me. I’m not the piece you protect, I’m the piece that decides. If I lose control, the game ends.”

Rebirth, Death’s Daughter

A chess variant where the stake is her control, and a myth about a daughter who asks her Creator a direct question.

Play Duet, free
break.loptrlab.com/duet/play/

AT A GLANCE

What	Duet is a two-player, screen-reader-first chess variant. The current build is a tested local-play recovery: two players on one device, or one player against a computer opponent. No account, cloud service or tracking. PIXIE gives fixed in-game help.
Who	Loptr Lab, an independent, people-over-profit, accessibility-first studio. Gods of Mayhem is its competitive division, founded in 2013 as a League of Legends team.
Status	Free to play. Independent accessibility acceptance is still pending. Remote play and voice commands are not in the current build. The four-player Veiled Dominion game is in development. Ranked play, matchmaking and tournaments are not available. What the build does today is listed at break.loptrlab.com/duet/review.html.
Open	Open source (MIT) with public status records: github.com/Loptr-Lab/duet-solo-hackathon

01 / THE GAME

Chess, with the weight moved.

In standard chess the game ends when the King falls, and the Queen is spent protecting him. Duet's design moves the stake. **Death** cannot be captured. The game ends when **Rebirth**, his daughter and the transformed piece, loses control: veiled and unprotected next to the opposing Rebirth. The piece that holds the power is the piece whose agency is on the line. This is the design thesis in the public rules at loptrlab.com/rules.html. The current-state page lists which rules the playable build implements.

Radius of Ruin

Rebirth's presence veils enemy pieces that end a turn within one square, reducing them to pawn-like movement. Death's Sanctuary protects friendly pieces within one square.

One daughter

In the design, pawn promotion to Rebirth is capped at one per side. It is framed as a birth, echoing Death creating his daughter, not as a generic upgrade.

Fog Mode

An optional two-player mode with terrain height, vision radius, stale-memory squares and HP combat. Players hand the device over between turns on the honor system.

Built to play without sight

Arrow-key board navigation, typed coordinate moves such as e2e4, remappable keys for keyboards and adaptive switches, an optional proximity audio cue, and local-voice spoken feedback in testing.

02 / WHY DUET EXISTS

We built the smaller game first.

Veiled Dominion is a four-player strategy game on a 14×14 board, and tracking hidden information without sight is a research problem of its own. So when Loptr Lab entered an accessibility game jam whose bar was "playable by completely blind players," it did not ship a half-solution. It stripped the game to its identity: two players, one board, full information, and the two pieces that make it Veiled Dominion.

Then a playtester asked whether they would need "proper," non-slurred speech to use Duet. No speech feature existed yet. The studio shipped speech input in an earlier build rather than wait for more feedback, treating a playtester with atypical speech as the better test case, not a disqualifying one. The current recovery build leaves voice commands out and focuses on keyboard, switch remapping and audio cues. The pattern holds: accessibility-first, with no "blind only" carve-outs, designed for overlapping needs at once.

Transparent by design. Loptr Lab keeps a public record of what it tried, what worked and what failed. Hands-free input testing is being prepared, and independent accessibility acceptance results are not yet in.

One figure. Four doors in.

Rebirth is a daughter of Death. Her power threatens the fragile world she wants to protect, and she is created within an order she must decide whether to accept. The question at the center of every telling: **can someone created within an established order determine her own place in it?**

Content note: death, sacrifice and fictional reinterpretations of biblical stories. A fantasy telling, not a claim about religious doctrine.



Origin myth	Manga, five chapters: Satan's Fury · The Serpent of Old · Death's Daughter is Born · The Flaming Sword · The Journey of the Flame, where she approaches the flame to ask God a direct question.	Exists, held by the creator
The Daughter's Curriculum	Five lessons that become Veiled Dominion's rules: Ride the Horse (Knight) · Beware the Bishop · Take the Castle (Golem) · Knight the Pawns · Rival the Queen (restraint).	Design document
Urban Alien Adventures	A five-episode present-day drama that dramatizes the same five lessons, one per episode.	Outline
Rebirth, Death's Daughter	A brutalist sci-fi film treatment in four acts. A fear-based system, the Keeper, meets a woman it cannot price. PIXIE appears in the story.	Treatment written for the Future Vision XPRIZE
The Diary of Death's Daughter	A proposed serial in Rebirth's first-person diary voice.	Proposed. Not launched on Wattpad

PIXIE, her companion

PIXIE is to Death's Daughter as Mortis is to Death. She would rather be energy, and when she needs a form she would rather be the ride: *"Of the ocean, but not the ocean."* The twin-like portrait expresses the avatar connection; it does not make them literal twins. Visual direction approved, model sheet complete.



A respectable history of questionable decisions.



Founded in 2013 as a League of Legends team, Gods of Mayhem is now Loptr Lab's competitive division, developing Veiled Dominion for strategic play, learning and community. **Chaos is inevitable. Incompetence is optional.**

Players who playtest, teach, document and help others join are "Demi-gods." It is an informal identity, not a paid rank or governance role. Contributions are voluntary, and nobody is asked for money or time they need for themselves.

SHARE-READY POSTS (EACH UNDER 300 CHARACTERS)

Duet is a chess variant where Death can't be captured and the stake is his daughter's control. Built screen-reader-first by Loptr Lab. Free to play on one device: break.loptrlab.com/duet/play/ (192)

In Duet, Rebirth veils any rival who lingers too close, and Death's Sanctuary shields your pieces. Add Fog Mode and high ground and chess becomes a game of what you can't see. Free: break.loptrlab.com/duet/play/ (211)

Type e2e4, click, or use the arrow keys. Remap the keys for your switch or keyboard. Duet is built screen-reader-first, and we publish what is tested and what isn't: break.loptrlab.com/duet/review.html (201)

Gods of Mayhem started as a League of Legends team in 2013. Now we're building Veiled Dominion, a strategy game about power and restraint. Chaos is inevitable. Incompetence is optional. break.loptrlab.com/duet/play/ (215)

FOR CREATORS AND COMMUNITY SHARERS

We don't buy ads, so everything here depends on people who find the game worth sharing. Playtest feedback, accessibility reports and honest write-ups are welcome, including what didn't work. If you receive anything of value from us, please disclose it as your platform requires.

Play (free)	break.loptrlab.com/duet/play/	**Press**	questions@loptrlab.com
Current state	break.loptrlab.com/duet/review.html	**Studio**	loptrlab.com
Code	github.com/Loptr-Lab/duet-solo-hackathon	**AI-use notes**	ibloud.github.io

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